

## Smiling Woman

There was an old woman who was always **in tears**. One day a **monk** asked her why she was always so sad.

"It's like this," said the woman. "One of my daughters is married to an umbrella seller while the other is married to a noodle maker. If it's sunny I feel sorry for the daughter who is married to the umbrella seller because I know her husband will not sell any umbrellas that day. If it's cloudy and looks like it's going to rain I feel sorry for my other daughter. Noodles have to be dried in the sun and if it's raining I know her husband won't have any noodles to sell the next day. In these parts it's nearly always either cloudy or sunny. That it is why I'm always so sad. You will agree with me that it's not at all possible for me to be happy in the **circumstances**."



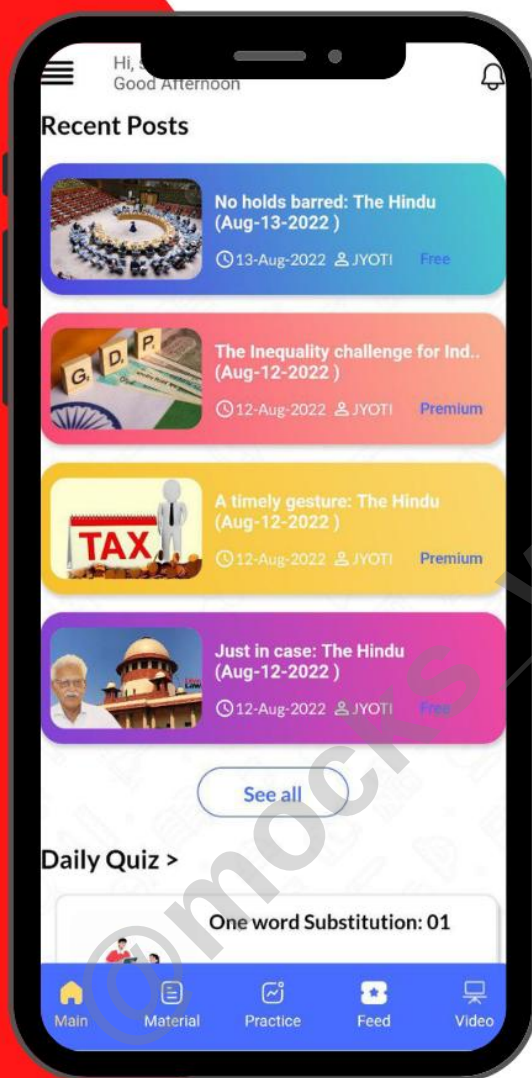
"As a matter of fact you are one of the **fortunate** few who are **ideally** placed to be happy at all times," said the monk. "The next time it's raining do not think of your daughter who is married to the noodle maker."

Think only of your daughter who is married to the umbrella seller. Imagine his joy, Imagine your daughter's joy. **Take delight** in their happiness. If it's sunny think only of the daughter who is married to the noodle maker. Imagine her husband's joy at being able to make so many noodles. Imagine your daughter's joy. Take delight in their happiness."

The woman did as the monk **advised**, and from then on nobody ever saw her with a sad face. She was always smiling. She became known as the 'Smiling Woman'.

### Vocabulary

1. **Be in tears** (phrase) – weep, sob, cry, wail, lament – आँसुओं में होना
2. **Monk** (noun) – ascetic, hermit, friar, mendicant, cleric – साधु
3. **Circumstance** (noun) – situation, condition, context, position, environment – परिस्थिति
4. **Fortunate** (adjective) – lucky, blessed, favored, prosperous, successful – भाग्यशाली
5. **Ideally** (adverb) – perfectly, suitably, optimally, appropriately, favorably – आदर्श रूप से
6. **Take delight** (phrase) – enjoy, relish, rejoice, savor, appreciate – आनंद लेना
7. **Advise** (verb) – suggest, recommend, counsel, urge, guide – सलाह देना



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